

when they can become independent. With no more rules to live by, curfews, or monitoring of their activities, young adults find that the financial costs of living on their own are outweighed by the benefits of this independence. For some young adults, though, these costs and benefits are reversed. They are not ready for the financial responsibility of living on their own, and prefer to be sheltered and taken care of by their parents. This nesting preference was the reason behind the Millers' financial problems.

When the Millers came in for their credit counseling appointment, they appeared to be extremely stressed. After the counselor had an opportunity to examine their budget, she discovered that they were \$500 short each month. The Millers were two months behind on their mortgage payment and the bank was threatening foreclosure.

The counselor noticed that some of their expenses seemed rather high. For example their food, electric, and water bills were higher than the average for two people. When the counselor pointed this out, the Millers informed the counselor that their adult daughter Rebecca, twenty-two years old, and her boyfriend lived with them. The daughter worked while her boyfriend spent the day at home. Even though the parents didn't require them to pay any rent, they had access to as much food as they desired and free use of electricity and water services.

The counselor suggested that the Millers charge their daughter and her boyfriend \$700 for rent. This way they would be able to pay their mortgage and still have some money left over to start a savings account. At first, the Millers resisted this idea, since their daughter and her boyfriend were family and not tenants. In the end, they changed their mind after they realized it was their best and possibly only solution to their money troubles.

